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Farewell Giorgio Chiellini

Legendary Italian defender Giorgio Chiellini (left) called time on his storied football career. Chiellini, who won the Serie A nine times with Juventus, played his farewell match with Los Angeles FC in the side's MLS Cup final defeat to Columbus Crew. The 39-year-old, who represented Italy 117 times, had retired from international football last year. Chiellini's greatest moment with the Azzuri came in 2021 when he captained his side to the Euro title.



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Manchester United's embarrassing UCL exit

Manchester United recorded one of the worst-ever UEFA Champions League campaigns by a Premier League side after it crashed to a 0-1 defeat to Bayern Munich in the final group stage match and finished last in its group.

United, which became the first Premier League side to finish bottom of a UCL group twice, also set the unwanted record for most goals conceded (15) by an English side in the group stage of a UCL season.



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Trailblazer Welch

The Premier League will have its first female referee when Rebecca Welch takes charge of Fulham's home game against Burnley later this month.

In November, Welch became the first female fourth official in a PL match, between Manchester United and Fulham.

The 40-year-old is a regular figure in the Women's Super League and was on duty at the Women's World Cup earlier this year.

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